

Sunday, 27 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 18° 12°	GLASGOW Rain 15° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A British national is among six people who have died after a suspected gas explosion close to the Acropolis in Athens.

Officials say four Americans and a Greek national were also killed in the blast. Investigations are now underway to determine the exact cause.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

Heathrow Airport is warning that its third runway project could be delayed by up to four years, potentially missing the 2035 target.

Ministers have already described the government deadline as "ambitious". This news raises concerns about future airport capacity.

TRANSPORT · UK
- 3

Police are re-examining CCTV footage in connection with the murder of Crimewatch presenter Jill Dando, who was shot in 1999.

Detectives are reviewing images of a man seen at Putney Bridge station around the time of the killing. It's hoped new technology might offer fresh clues.

CRIME · UK
- 4

The Housing Secretary has criticised proposed changes to visa rules, ahead of the Labour Party conference this weekend.

Angela Rayner argues that altering wait times for permanent residency is unfair because it "changes the goalposts" for those seeking to settle in the UK.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

The High Court has granted an injunction to stop the Orange Order's Drumcree parade in Portadown.

Portadown District Orange Lodge had declined a request to postpone the parade. The judge cited the fundamental importance of the issue to Northern Irish society.

NORTHERN IRELAND · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The shortlist for this year's prestigious Booker Prize has been revealed, following a "tussle" among the judges.**

Past winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees. The literary world is now buzzing with predictions for who will take home the coveted award.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted books? Which author are you rooting for?

BOOKS · COMING UP
- 2 Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her new role as a former cocaine dealer on "funny Welsh people" she knows.**

She plays Jackie Price in the upcoming film 'Kill Jackie', a character targeted by assassins. It sounds like a fascinating and potentially humorous performance!

ON AIR – What kind of roles do you love seeing Catherine Zeta-Jones in? Does this sound like a good fit?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3 Rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to organisations supporting Palestinians.**

The tour, which begins in Dublin next month, follows his recent fallout with Ed Sheeran. It's certainly a strong statement from the artist.

ON AIR – Macklemore's tour is sure to get people talking. What do you make of artists using their platform for political causes?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 An Indian film from Nagaland, 'Angh', is now on a path towards the Oscars after a major win at Toronto.**

The film brings a rarely seen world to global cinema, offering a unique perspective. It's exciting to see international cinema gaining such recognition.

ON AIR – Do you love discovering films from different parts of the world? What's the last international film that really impressed you?

FILM · COMING UP
- 5 Burberry closed London Fashion Week 2026 with its signature check print and a star-studded front row.**

The event showcased the biggest trends for wardrobes next year. Fashionistas will be keen to see what styles emerge from the show.

ON AIR – What's your take on the latest fashion trends? Are you someone who follows them, or do you stick to your own style?

FASHION · WHEN

On the schedule

- 1 George Russell has won the Azerbaijan Grand Prix, holding off a late challenge from Red Bull's Max Verstappen.**

The race was enlivened by two late safety car periods, making for a thrilling finish. It's a fantastic result for Mercedes!

ON AIR – What a race! Did you think Verstappen was going to snatch it at the end? Who impressed you most on the track?

F1 · UK
- 2 England's Red Roses have secured a dramatic victory over New Zealand, with Zoe Harrison scoring a last-gasp try.**

The win at Allianz Stadium means England avoid a second successive draw in the WXV Global Series. What a way to finish!

ON AIR – Did you catch that incredible last-minute try? What does this win mean for the Red Roses' confidence going forward?

RUGBY · UK
- 3 Warwickshire have sealed their ninth County Championship title with an innings victory against Leicestershire.**

It's a fantastic achievement for the team, completing their triumph in style. Cricket fans will be celebrating this win.

ON AIR – A huge congratulations to Warwickshire! For cricket fans, what makes a County Championship win so special?

CRICKET · UK
- 4 Warrington Wolves have reached their first Super League Grand Final in eight years after a thrilling win over Leeds Rhinos.**

The semi-final clash was incredibly close, but Warrington edged it to secure their spot. Fans will be buzzing for the final!

ON AIR – What a performance from Warrington! Are you a fan of Super League, and who are you backing in the Grand Final?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK
- 5 Manchester City chairman Khaldoon Al Mubarak says he is still confident the club will prove its innocence.**

This comes after they were found guilty of breaking Premier League financial rules. The chairman's comments suggest a strong belief in their defence.

ON AIR – The Man City financial rules saga continues. Do you think they'll be able to clear their name, or are sanctions inevitable?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The simple pleasure of 'window box gardening' is seeing a charming resurgence across towns and cities.**
Many are discovering the joy of bringing a splash of colour and nature to their homes, even with limited space. It's a lovely way to brighten up a street!
- 2 Experts are suggesting that 'storytelling with family photos' can be a wonderful way to connect generations.**
Instead of just looking at old pictures, taking the time to share the stories behind them creates lasting memories and laughter. Dig out those albums!
- 3 A new report highlights the growing popularity of 'vintage board game nights' amongst friends and families.**
It seems we're all enjoying a nostalgic trip back to simpler times, with classic games providing hours of screen-free fun and friendly competition.
- 4 The delightful trend of 'creative packed lunch ideas' is encouraging us to ditch the mundane.**
From Bento box artistry to themed meals, people are finding fun ways to make midday meals more exciting, whether for school or work.
- 5 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'animal empathy' and how different species show care for one another.**
From elephants comforting their friends to birds sharing food, it's a heartwarming reminder of nature's compassionate side.
- 6 The charming practice of 'leaving encouraging notes in library books' is spreading smiles.**
Readers are tucking little messages of positivity into borrowed books, creating a lovely chain of unexpected kindness for the next person to discover.
- 7 A recent study suggests that 'listening to instrumental film scores' can boost concentration during everyday tasks.**
Turns out, those epic movie tunes aren't just for the big screen; they can help us focus while doing chores or working from home!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WARMING THE TEACUP FIRST, EVEN IF IT'S JUST A QUICK RINSE WITH HOT WATER!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A GENTLE SHAKE TO HEAR HOW CRUNCHY THEY SOUND BEFORE OPENING!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't had one in years?

What's that biscuit for you, and what lovely memory does it conjure up?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's a simple act of kindness that someone's done for you recently that really stuck with you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that some species of fish can recognise human faces, even after a long period of time?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's been discovered that if you plant a pineapple upside down, it will grow faster and be sweeter.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament, which seems rather fitting for wise birds.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, located in New Zealand.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if they could just hold their breath long enough.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, was buried in one upon his request.
- Chocolate was once used as currency in the Aztec Empire.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia micra, can fit comfortably on the tip of a human finger.
- The first ever recorded weather forecast was published in a British newspaper in 1861.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.

On this day

Day 270 of the year, 95 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Adheritus; Christian feast days: Bonfilius; Christian feast days: Caius of Milan; Christian feast days: Hiltrude of Liessies. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Austin Carlile, American singer-songwriter
- 1958 — Irvine Welsh, Scottish author and playwright
- 1992 — Sam Lerner, American actor
- 1936 — Gordon Honeycombe, English actor, playwright, and author (died 2015)
- 1982 — Jon McLaughlin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1948 — A Martinez, American actor
- 1982 — Lil Wayne, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1956 — Martin Handford, English children's author and illustrator

THE DAY TODAY

- 2003 — The SMART-1 satellite is launched.
- 2019 — Over two million people participated in worldwide strikes to protest climate change across 2,400 locations worldwide.
- 1988 — The National League for Democracy is formed by Aung San Suu Kyi and others to fight dictatorship in Myanmar.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1949 — Zeng Liansong's design is chosen as the flag of the People's Republic of China.
- 1975 — The last use of capital punishment in Spain sparks worldwide protests.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — World War II: The Kassel Mission results in the largest loss by a USAAF group on any mission during the war.
- 2008 — CNSA astronaut Zhai Zhigang becomes the first Chinese person to perform a spacewalk.
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1941 — World War II: The Greek National Liberation Front is established with Georgios Siantos as acting leader.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 271 of the year, 94 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Auxerre; Christian feast day: Amalia Abad Casasempere; Christian feast day: Annemund; Christian feast day: Chariton the Confessor. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1981 — Jerrika Hinton, American actress
- 1987 — Gary Deegan, Irish footballer
- 1967 — Mira Sorvino, American actress
- 2000 — Frankie Jonas, American actor, singer, and songwriter
- 1975 — Isamu Jordan, American journalist and academic (died 2013)
- 1938 — Ben E. King, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2015)
- 1935 — Ronald Lacey, English actor (died 1991)
- 1981 — Greg Anderson, American pianist and composer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1958 — Fernando Rios, a Mexican tour guide in New Orleans, dies of injuries sustained in an incident of gay bashing.
- 1983 — John Pat, a 16-year old Aboriginal Australian boy, dies of injuries sustained by four off-duty police officers in Roebourne, a catalyst to the Royal Commission into Aboriginal Deaths in Custody.
- 2012 — Sita Air Flight 601 crashes in Madhyapur Thimi, Nepal, killing all 19 passengers and crew.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1994 — The cruise ferry MS Estonia sinks in the Baltic Sea, killing 852 people.
- 1995 — Bob Denard and a group of mercenaries take the islands of the Comoros in a coup.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar